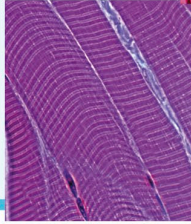


MUSCLE TISSUE

There are three main types of muscle tissue. What we usually think of as “muscles” are skeletal muscles. Also called voluntary or striated muscles, most skeletal muscles are joined to bones and produce bodily movements under conscious control. Smooth muscles, also called involuntary muscles as they are not under conscious control, occur in the walls of body parts such as the airways and blood vessels. Cardiac muscle forms the walls of the heart.

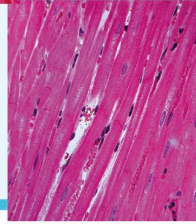
SKELETAL

A microscope view shows pronounced stripes, bands, or striations, created by the alignment of muscle fibrils.



SMOOTH

The light microscope reveals few features: principally tapered muscle cells with dark nuclei.



CARDIAC

Fibres in heart (cardiac) muscle are short and branching, often Y- or V-shaped, with faint banding or striations.

